



7.01 Defensive Driving

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps in Defensive Driving and Travelling Alone.

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use by all Silverpoint employees.

3. Hazard Identification

- Physical Stress .
- Mental Stress
- Personal Injury .
- Slips, Trips and Falls .
- Lifting , Bending , and Twisting .
- Hot Fluids .
- Visibility .
- Getting Lost .
- Animals .
- Breakdowns .
- Accidents .
- Weather Conditions .
- Road hazards
- Slopes

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls .
- Steel Toed Boots .
- Safety Glasses .
- Hard Hat .



- Gloves
- Hearing Protection .
- Defensive Driving Training . (GODI and/or Off Highway Driving)
- Seat Belts .
- Pre-Trip Inspection .
- Preventive Maintenance Procedure .
- Hours of Service Regulation .

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice
- Alberta OH&S
- Highway Traffic Act
- Silverpoint Task List
- Silverpoint THA 7.01

Smoking is not permitted in any Silverpoint equipment

6. Procedure

6.1. Seat Belts

In all provinces , the law requires the use of seat belts while occupying a vehicle . Your vehicle maybe equipped with an air bag ,but this does not excuse you from wearing a seat belt. The air bag was meant as a supplement tool to save lives ,not as a replacement for the seat belt. A properly adjusted seat belt is positioned directly over the hips , not the stomach . The shoulder strap should be positioned on the shoulder , not under the armpit or behind the occupant . A lap and shoulder belt ,properly used , can help reduce the severity of injuries in a crash :

6.2. Vehicle Maintenance

6.2.1. Defensive driving starts and ends with vehicle maintenance . A vehicle must be checked for deficiencies before , during and after a trip. Refer to the Pre/Post trip SOP 2.08 for more information on this. Make sure to check for loose loads . Make sure that everything is strapped down with good nylon ratchet straps , tarp straps are not a legal way of primary load securement . They are only allowed as secondary means , such as holding the end of the hose to the beaver tail.



6.3. Plan Your Route

6.3.1. Before leaving on a trip, plan a route according to time and weather. Leave with adequate time to arrive at the desired location and plan for any type of climate conditions. It is a good idea to tune into a local weather channel for the daily forecast. Keep an updated map with you. If it is necessary to look at the map, pull off to the side of the road, at a rest stop or gas station.

6.3.2. **DO NOT TRY TO READ A MAP AND DRIVE.** If you do get lost, stay calm and call your Supervisor for help.

7. Cell Phones , PDA's, GPS:

DO NOT SEND OR RECEIVE TEXTS , MAKE OR SEND PHONE CALLS OR EMAILS WHILE DRIVING !

- Alberta Distracted Driving Legislation (Bill 16) Effective September 1st, 2011
- Restricts drivers from:
 - using hand-held cell phones , texting , or e-mailing
 - using electronic devices like laptop computers , video games , cameras , video entertainment displays and programming portable audio players (e.g., MP3 players)
 - entering information on GPS units
 - reading printed materials in the vehicle
 - writing , printing , or sketching , and personal grooming
- Complements the current driving without due care and attention legislation
- Applies to all vehicles as defined by the Traffic Safety Act, including bicycles
- Applies to all roads in both urban and rural areas of the province
- The fine for this new offence is \$390 plus 3 demerits and up.

8. Drivers Conditions

8.1. It is very important when planning trips to make a sleep plan. Make sure that the primary driver is allowed at least six hours of sleep the night before the trip. If there is more than one occupant in the vehicle , consider a driving rotation . Below are two separate lists to detect a drowsy driver and help keep him/her awake .

8.2. **Danger Signs**

8.2.1. Eyes closing and/or lose focus .

8.2.2. Difficulty keeping your head up.

8.2.3. Constant yawning .



- 8.2.4. Wandering and disconnected thoughts .
- 8.2.5. Do not remember driving for a few minutes .
- 8.2.6. Missing the exits .
- 8.2.7. Consistently driving through or over the line .
- 8.2.8. Speed becomes variable

8.3. Tips for Staying Alert while Driving

- 8.3.1. There is no substitute for sleep .
- 8.3.2. Get rest and do not start a trip late in the day .
- 8.3.3. Avoid driving at night .
- 8.3.4. Adjust the vehicles environment to stay awake . Changing the temperature in vehicle .
- 8.3.5. Watch your posture .
- 8.3.6. Snack on some food or drink .
- 8.3.7. Take frequent breaks and exercise .

8.4. Safe Driving Distance

- 8.4.1. One way to practice defensive driving is to keep a good consistent driving distance from the leading vehicle .
A good tool to use is the three-second following rule .
- 8.4.2. The three-second following rule is performed like this :
- 8.4.3. Fix your attention on the lead vehicle . When it passes a recognizable object like a line in the road or sign , start counting , "One Mississippi , two Mississippi , three Mississippi " until you reach that object . If you reach the object before three , you are driving too close to the leading vehicle . Slow your vehicle and do the procedure again to obtain a proper driving distance between the leading vehicle and yourself .
- 8.4.4. In poor driving conditions , add one or more seconds between you and the lead vehicle .

8.5. Braking Distance

- 8.5.1. A vehicle cannot stop on a dime . That is why the three-second following rule is so important . If you can maintain a proper distance with the lead vehicle , you can stop safely without a collision . In an ideal situation , perception of a stopping situation is about one second and reaction to that situation is an additional three-fourths of a second . Again , this is for an ideal situation , the variable for this situation is weather , speed , road conditions , fatigue , alcohol , or drug use . The faster the speed , the harder is to stop . On ice- or snow-covered roads it will take a longer distance to stop .



8.6. Approaching Intersections

- 8.6.1. Most accidents occur at an intersection , three to four seconds after light changes . If you are aware and cautious when driving through an intersection , you can greatly reduce the likelihood of an accident . Below is a list of tips that can help when approaching an intersection .
- 8.6.2. As you approach an intersection , never assume that the vehicle will stop . So, start braking in advance about 200 to 300 meters on secondary roads (gravel roads) . If at highway speed start braking about 500 to 600 meters in advance . This means , approach the intersection with caution .
- 8.6.3. Always look both ways carefully before proceeding . It is good practice to wait two or three seconds before proceeding through the intersection .
- 8.6.4. If you are approaching an intersection where the light has been green for some time, cover the brake with your foot in case the light changes , this way you can apply the brakes quicker .
- 8.6.5. A good indication on whether a light is about to change is the crosswalk signal . If it has the walk icon up, then the light will not change ; however , if it has the blinking do not cross icon , then be prepared to stop .

Always be aware of pedestrians at intersections . Remember , pedestrians have the right of way.

8.7. Control Factor

Every time you get behind the wheel , there are some factors that you can control to ensure a safe trip .

- 8.7.1. Factors you CAN control :
- 8.7.2. Emotions – good or bad .
- 8.7.3. Vehicle condition . Doing PMIs and a proper pre trip inspection every time you enter the truck .
- 8.7.4. Adjust the vehicle speed for the conditions of the roads .
- 8.7.5. Position in traffic and space around vehicle .
- 8.7.6. Concentration on a given task . Knowing your destination and the route you are going to take .

8.8. Factors you have NO control over:

- 8.8.1. Weather .
- 8.8.2. The other drivers .



8.8.3. Traffic.

8.8.4. Force of impact .

8.8.5. Energy of motion .

8.9. Oil company right of way practices and procedures

8.9.1. Oil Company's may have different policies regarding right of way for the traffic in their area, it will be the responsibility of each operator to ask at the beginning of the job what that specific oil company's policies are regarding right of way.

8.9.2. This should be recorded on the safety meeting and communicated between operators and covered at any operator switch outs.

8.9.3. There are times when specific policies don't always apply to all situations , if all drivers show courtesy for each other and pull over where there is room to let the other truck pass safely the possibility of an incident will be reduced .

8.10. Winter Driving

8.10.1. When driving on ice roads , many company's policies are that the smaller vehicle will give right of way to the larger vehicles .

8.10.2. It is the responsibility of each operator to ask at the beginning of the job what that specific oil company's policies are regarding right of way on ice roads . Relays this information to any coworkers or cross shifts .

8.10.3. Drive within the speed limit for these roads or even slower in case you need to take evasive or corrective action .

8.11. General driving practices

8.11.1. Slow down on rough roads , washboard , and soft spots . Keep dust to minimum ; slow down when going past farmyards , not using your Jake brake . Do not use you Jake brakes on location or in soft fields , this may affect your being able to shift properly . The reason we don't use the Jake brakes on location is that there could be someone sleeping . Watch for soft spots in the road , rocks , and steep ditches . Always be aware of your surroundings .

8.11.2. When you are driving in the spread field many of the above hazards apply, slopes , rocks , holes in the field, cow trails , access to the field and soft spots . It is always a good practice to see the spread field in the daytime , if possible , even if you have to delay going to sleep for an hour at least that gives you an idea of what the field looks like , and the possible hazards .



- 8.11.3 . Chains – Refer to SOP 2.03 and TPC SOP 2.04 on putting chains on properly . There are only a few places that will allow you to run chains on the highway , such as in the mountains or big river hills, these places have signs indicating that in poor driving conditions you should chain up before going thru the area . Other than these specific places we do not normally run chains on the highway .
- 8.11.4 . Tire chains are allowed when a truck is crossing a paved highway as long as there is no damage to the roadway . Always inspect the roadway after crossing for damage from the tire chains . If you see any type of indents or scarring from the tire chains , you must remove them before crossing again .

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your Supervisor